

Authentication

At the end of this episode, I will be able to:

1. Authentication

Learner Objective: *Learn about authentication options in modern wireless networks*

Description: In this episode, you will learn about the authentication options commonly used in wireless networks today.

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- Open authentication - this is the most simple method of authentication. The user finds the SSID of the network they want to connect to - and then they simply connect to the network. Notice there is no proof of identity and no encryption in use. These networks are discouraged, of course. Even in common public areas where they had been used in the past.
 - Pre-shared key - WPA2-pre-shared key is another option. This uses the concept of a shared secret passcode for the WiFi network. This option is found in public settings like restaurants and coffee shops. This method of authentication is frowned upon in office environments.
 - WPA2-Enterprise requires authentication with a unique identifier. This requires the use of a secure EAP method of authentication and can even be configured for MFA usage. Certificates are quickly replacing passwords for WPA2-Enterprise usage in organizations today.
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Additional Resources:

What is the Most Secure Method of WiFi Authentication

<https://www.securew2.com/blog/what-is-the-most-secure-method-of-wi-fi-authentication>